

GCC Cross-Border Hold Procedure

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

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Purpose

To provide a consistent response for road shipments delayed at GCC border crossings, including cases where the reason is initially unclear.

Scope

Applies to ARLS-managed road freight moving between Saudi Arabia and GCC countries, including subcontracted carriers and transit movements.

1. Mandatory evidence

- Driver/vehicle identifier and carrier name.
- Border/crossing location and arrival timestamp.
- Latest confirmed queue, inspection, customs or document status.
- Driver contact status and latest written carrier update.
- Transport and commercial document availability.
- Fuel, temperature-control, driver-hours and cargo-security risks where relevant.

2. Response by elapsed time

Hold duration	Response
0-4 hours	Carrier dispatcher owns update cadence; Control Tower records status.
4-8 hours	Request documented reason, queue status and expected processing checkpoint.
8-12 hours	Regional Road Ops reviews alternate routing and driver-hours constraints.
12-24 hours	Account Owner informed; customer notified if delivery commitment is at risk.
>24 hours	Regional Operations Manager leads incident; updates at least every 4 hours.
>48 hours	Executive operations review for high-value, temperature-sensitive or penalty-exposed cargo.

3. Rerouting controls

- Do not reroute across a different border until customs/transit feasibility, carrier capability, driver legality and customer impact are checked.
- High-value shipments require Duty Manager approval before a material route change.
- Record incremental distance, cost estimate, ETA impact and proposed border route before approval.

4. Unknown-cause handling

- Use a cross-border / reason-pending classification when the carrier cannot confirm the cause.
- Agent summaries must separate confirmed facts from assumptions.

- Escalation requests should ask for the specific missing confirmation: queue, customs, inspection, document, vehicle or driver-hours issue.

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.